

Word family: **interview / interviews / interviewed / interviewing / interviewer / interviewee**

Base word: interview

Plural: interviews

Past tense: interviewed

Past participle: interviewed

***-ing* form:** interviewing

Related forms: interviewer, interviewee

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “He loves talking about old Hong Kong, unusual people he **interviewed**, books, films...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **interviewed** means that Mr. Wong, as a journalist, **asked people questions in an organized conversation in order to obtain information, opinions, experiences, or material for a radio report or programme**.

繁體中文： **以記者身分有目的地向某人提問和交談，以取得資料、觀點、經歷或可供報道的內容**

中文翻譯：

> “...unusual people he **interviewed** ...”

「.....他曾經**訪問 / 採訪過**的特別人物.....」

Here:

interview someone = 以有目的、有組織的方式向某人提問，以取得資料、意見或經歷

1. **interview + person for journalism/media/research (採訪 / 訪問) — 訪問；採訪**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To ask someone questions in a planned conversation in order to obtain information, opinions, experiences, or material for journalism, research, broadcasting, etc.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He loves talking about unusual people he **interviewed**.”

「他很喜歡談自己曾經**訪問 / 採訪過**的特別人物。」

Practice 2

> “The journalist **interviewed** several residents about the changes in the neighbourhood.”

「記者就社區的變化**訪問了**幾位居民。」

Practice 3

> “She was **interviewed** for a documentary about Hong Kong culture.”

「她為一部有關香港文化的紀錄片接受了**訪問**。」

****interview someone** = 以有組織的提問方式，從某人身上取得可供報道、研究或公開呈現的資料******

Common:

- * interview a politician
- * interview a witness
- * interview an artist
- * interview residents
- * interview someone for a documentary

These share one broad ****information-gathering conversation**** sense.

2. ****interview + job applicant (求職) — 面試****

This is a very common specialized use.

****Meaning:**** To formally ask a job applicant questions in order to assess whether they are suitable for a position.

Practice 4

> “The company **interviewed** six candidates for the position.”

「公司為這個職位**面試了**六名候選人。」

Practice 5

> “She was **interviewed** by two senior managers.”

「她接受了兩名高級經理的**面試**。」

****interview someone for a job = 正式向求職者提問，以評估其經驗、能力和是否適合某個職位****

This deserves a separate practical sense because the purpose is not primarily gathering information for publication or research, but ****selection and assessment****.

3. ****an interview = job-selection meeting (求職會面) — 面試****

As a noun, ****interview**** commonly means the formal meeting itself.

Practice 6

> “I have a job ****interview**** tomorrow morning.”

「我明天早上有一個工作****面試****。」

Practice 7

> “The ****interview**** lasted about forty minutes.”

「這次****面試****大約持續了四十分鐘。」

****an interview = 僱主與求職者正式交談和提問，以評估是否適合聘用的會面****

For database counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 as the noun counterpart of the same employment-assessment concept.

4. ****an interview = recorded/published conversation (媒體訪談) — 訪問；訪談****

As a noun, ****interview**** can also mean the conversation or resulting media content produced from interviewing someone.

Practice 8

> “I listened to an ****interview**** with the director.”

「我聽了一段對那位導演的****訪談****。」

Practice 9

> “The magazine published a long ****interview**** with the actor.”

「這本雜誌刊登了一篇對那位演員的長篇**訪問**。」

****an interview = 記者、主持人等與某人進行的有目的問答，以及由此形成的廣播、文章或節目內容****

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1 because the semantic concept remains:

> ****structured questioning for information/media content****

The shift from verb to noun does not by itself justify another core meaning.

5. ****interview + participant/patient/witness for investigation/research (研究 / 調查) — 訪談；詢問****

****Interview**** is also used in research, social science, investigations, medicine, and other formal information-gathering settings.

Practice 10

> “Researchers ****interviewed**** fifty participants.”

「研究人員****訪談了****五十名參加者。」

Practice 11

> “The investigator ****interviewed**** witnesses separately.”

「調查人員分別****詢問 / 訪談了****幾名證人。」

****interview someone = 透過有計劃、有目的的提問取得研究、調查或專業所需資料****

For database counting, I would ****merge this with Meaning 1****.

The domain changes, but the core idea remains:

> ****systematic information-gathering conversation****

The Golden Manual specifically says that changing the industry or setting does not automatically create a new lexical sense when the underlying concept remains the same.

Related form: ****interviewer****

An **interviewer** is the person who asks the questions.

Practice 12

> “The **interviewer** asked about her previous experience.”

「**面試官 / 訪問者**詢問了她以前的經驗。」

Practice 13

> “A good **interviewer** listens carefully to the answers.”

「好的**訪問者 / 訪談者**會仔細聆聽對方的回答。」

interviewer = 在面試、訪談、研究或媒體訪問中負責提出問題的人

The natural Chinese depends on context:

* job interview → 面試官

* journalism → 訪問者 / 記者 / 主持人

* research → 訪談員

Related form: **interviewee**

An **interviewee** is the person who is being interviewed.

Practice 14

> “The **interviewee** seemed relaxed throughout the conversation.”

「那位**受訪者 / 面試者**在整段談話中看起來都很放鬆。」

Practice 15

> “Each **interviewee** was asked the same ten questions.”

「每位**受訪者**都被問了相同的十條問題。」

interviewee = 在面試、訪問或研究訪談中回答問題的人

Again, Chinese changes by context:

* media/research → 受訪者

* employment → 面試者 / 求職者

Important distinction: **interview vs conversation**

conversation

is broad and may be casual, spontaneous, or social.

interview

has a specific purpose and usually involves one side asking structured questions.

> “We had a conversation about his career.”

= 我們聊了他的事業。

> “I interviewed him about his career.”

= 我有目的地就他的事業向他提問和收集資料。

So:

conversation = general two-way talk

interview = purposeful structured questioning

Important distinction: **interview vs question**

question someone

can simply mean ask them questions, sometimes intensively or formally.

interview someone

usually suggests a more organized session with a recognized purpose.

> “Police questioned him.”

may sound investigative.

> “Researchers interviewed him.”

suggests a structured research conversation.

There is overlap, but **interview** usually implies a defined interaction rather than isolated questioning.

Important distinction: **interview vs interrogate**

interview

is neutral and can apply to:

- * journalism
- * jobs
- * research
- * investigations

interrogate

means question someone intensively, especially in police, military, or security contexts.

> “The journalist interviewed him.”

neutral.

> “The suspect was interrogated.”

much stronger and more coercive.

So learners should not use **interrogate** as a general synonym for **interview**.

Important distinction: **interview vs audition**

These are especially easy to confuse in recruitment for performance roles.

interview

usually assesses someone through questions and discussion.

audition

assesses performance ability by having the person act, sing, dance, play music, etc.

> “She interviewed for the job.”

> “She auditioned for the role.”

Different assessment methods.

Important distinction: **interview vs survey**

interview

usually involves direct questioning of an individual, often allowing follow-up.

survey

usually collects standardized responses from many people, often through a questionnaire.

A research project may use both:

> interviews + surveys

They are not interchangeable methods.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **interview**

* **interviews**

* **interviewed**

* **interviewing**

* **interviewer**

* **interviewee**

The family is semantically quite clean.

The main distinction worth preserving is:

1. **information-gathering interview** — journalism, research, investigation, media
2. **selection interview** — employment/admission-style assessment

The Golden Manual says related person nouns such as **-er** and **-ee** should be actively checked during the word-family sweep when they are common and useful.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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interview — journalism/media/research	透過有目的、有組織的提問，從某人取得資料、觀點、經歷或可供報道 / 研究的內容
an interview — media/research conversation	記者、主持人或研究者與某人進行的有目的問答 / 訪談；屬於同一信息收集概念
interview — employment selection	正式向求職者提問，以評估其經驗、能力及是否適合某個職位
a job interview	僱主與求職者正式交談和提問，以評估是否聘用的會面
interviewer	在面試、訪談或研究中負責提出問題的人
interviewee	在面試、訪問或研究訪談中回答問題的人

For your original sentence

> “...unusual people he **interviewed** ...”

The exact meaning is:

interview = 以記者身分有目的、有組織地向某人提問，以取得資料、意見、經歷或可供報道的內容

So:

> **people he interviewed**

= **他曾經訪問 / 採訪過的人**

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely distinct core meanings** for **interview**:

1. **journalism/research/investigation — structured questioning to obtain information**
2. **employment/selection — formally assess a candidate through questions**

I would merge **journalism, research, documentary, witness, and media interviews** under #1 rather than split them by domain, and treat **interviewer / interviewee** as useful family extensions rather than additional meanings.